GLIMEPIRIDE

Once daily

Hypoglycaemia

CHEMICAL NAME 3-ethyl-4-methyl-N-[2-[4-[(trans-4-methylcyclohexyl)carbamoylsulfamoyl]phenyl]ethyl]-2-oxo-2,5-dihydro-1H-pyrrole-1-carboxamide

CLASS Second-generation (third-generation) sulfonylurea

TRADE NAMES Amaryl · Glimy · Amaryl M (with metformin)

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Type 2 diabetes (alone or with metformin, insulin).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Stimulates **insulin release** via β-cell KATP channel closure; some extrapancreatic insulin-sensitising effects.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily immediately before or with breakfast.

DOSAGES

- **Start:** 1 mg once daily; increase by 1 mg every 1–2 weeks.
- **Usual:** 1–4 mg daily; max 6 mg/day.
- Elderly/renal: start 1 mg.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 2–3 h. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP2C9) to weakly active metabolites.
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** 5–9 h.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Weight gain.
- Dizziness, headache.
- GI upset.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hypoglycaemia.
- Haemolytic anaemia (G6PD), thrombocytopenia.
- Hepatitis, cholestasis (rare).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Type 1 diabetes, DKA.
- Severe renal or hepatic impairment.
- Sulfonylurea/sulfonamide hypersensitivity; pregnancy, breastfeeding.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **CYP2C9 inhibitors (fluconazole):** ↑ levels.
- **Alcohol, β-blockers:** hypoglycaemia/masking.
- **Rifampicin:** ↓ effect.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Glucose monitoring; give with breakfast.
- Monitor HbA1c, weight, renal function.
- Hold if NBM.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take with breakfast once a day.
- Never skip meals after taking.
- Carry glucose; recognise hypos.

KEY POINTS

- Once-daily sulfonylurea.
- Hypoglycaemia, weight gain.
- 1–4 mg daily (max 6 mg).
- Take with breakfast.

SOURCES CHECKED **[604]** Glimepiride 1 mg tablets (UK SmPC) **[605]** Glimepiride, oral (US label) **[606]** Glimepiride, oral (US label, Proficient Rx LP) *Full references p. 432–457*